

# Holly Ambler

Senior UX Researcher | Mixed Methods Research

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Senior UX Researcher specializing in generative and evaluative mixed-methods research across enterprise cloud, security, and endpoint management products. Deep expertise in Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) frameworks and AI/Copilot usability research, translating qualitative insight into product strategy and roadmap decisions. MS in Human Centered Design and Engineering.

## SKILLS

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**Research Methods:** Mixed Methods Research, Generative Research, Evaluative Research, Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD), Requirements Gathering, Customer Journey Mapping, Contextual Inquiry, Concept Testing, Cognitive Walkthrough, Usability Testing, Heuristic Evaluation, Survey Design, Focus Groups, Interviewing, Single Ease Question (SEQ), SWOT Analysis, Funnel Analysis

**Design & Strategy:** Wireframing, Information Architecture, Responsible AI, Accessibility, Project Management

**Tools:** FigJam, Marvin, Copilot, Claude, Lovable, Microsoft Office Suite

## EXPERIENCE

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### Senior UX Researcher — Microsoft

*Jan 2018 – Jul 2026 | Redmond, WA*

- Lead generative and evaluative mixed-methods UX researcher for Intune, Microsoft's cloud-based endpoint management solution, surfacing deep qualitative insight on user behavior, motivations, and pain points that informed the product roadmap and major design decisions.
- Conducted generative research identifying AI opportunities across the product, informing feature direction and prioritization.
- Ran mixed-methods investigations into admin context-switching across management portals, surfacing friction points that shaped core device-management workflow improvements.
- Led a major overhaul of Intune's information architecture through multiple rounds of terminology studies, card sorts, and tree tests.
- Ran usability studies evaluating Copilot discoverability, usability, and fitness for purpose within Intune, guiding design coherence, funnel analysis, and responsible AI integration decisions.

### Principal User Experience Researcher (Dual Role) — EMC / Dell (Isilon)

*Oct 2013 – Jan 2018 | Greater Seattle Area*

- Established and led the UX practice at Isilon.
- Partnered with teams across the organization to define user-centric interactions and workflows for the OneFS operating system and its companion product, InsightIQ.
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative research into user needs, translating findings into UX writing, design recommendations, and product decisions.
- Regularly presented findings to Executive leadership.

### Senior Content Developer (Dual Role) — EMC / Dell (Isilon)

*Oct 2013 – Dec 2015 | Seattle, WA*

- Researched, designed, and maintained 23 internal troubleshooting guides; awarded the Isilon Cluster Award (2014).
- Authored EMC Technical Advisories, coordinating a multi-phase review process with Isilon Executive Management and EMC Legal.
- Wrote patch READMEs and knowledge base articles, ensuring timely, actionable, and technically accurate documentation.
- Conducted extensive user research and developed personas that were widely adopted across product teams.
- Designed test plans, moderated user tests, and authored usability reports and field studies for high-visibility projects.
- Co-founded the ID-Strategy team, a UX specialist group reporting directly to the department Director.

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Communications Lead — JPMC:** Designed communication strategy and authored technical documentation and information architecture for a 175-person application development, hosting, and QA/QC organization.

**Technical Writer and Editor — JPMC / WaMu:** Authored technical documentation, brochures, and training materials across application development, cloud architecture, security, and technology governance teams.

## EDUCATION

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**MS, Human Centered Design and Engineering** — University of Washington